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DeepL - Monetization

Designing hard blockers across DeepL Translator and Write

I wrote a family of upgrade prompts for usage limits, feature limits and product-access blocks across Translator and Write.

My role

UX copywriter and content designer for the hard-blocker experiment wave

Worked with

Monetization, product design, content design, product management and engineering

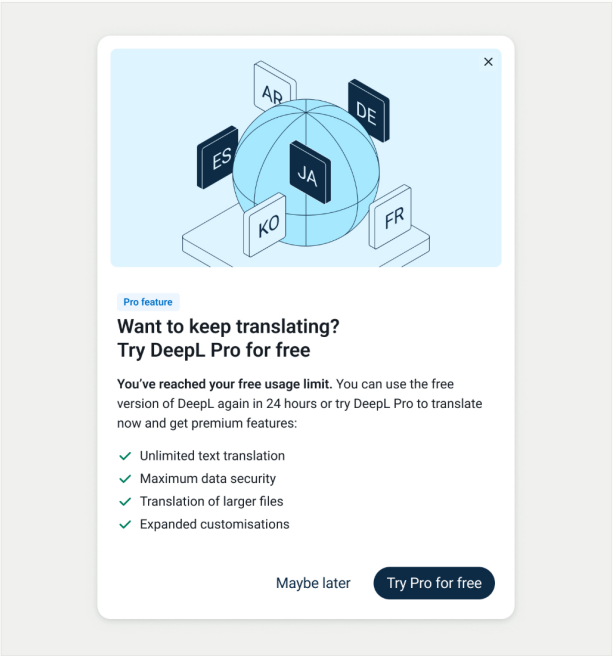
Why it mattered

Each blocker needed to explain why work stopped and make the paid route relevant to the task in progress.

01 - The experience

One blocker pattern, adapted to the reason work stopped

Usage limit



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The usage-limit blocker explains when free access returns before presenting the paid route to continue translating.

02 - The problem

Each blocker needed to explain why work stopped and make the paid route relevant to the task in progress.

The blockers shared a commercial goal, but not one user story. Reaching a translation limit, exhausting a file allowance and losing access to a paid Write feature each required a different explanation.

Across the wave, the repeated content jobs were consistent: explain the block, connect the paid value to the interrupted task, name the relevant product and give the user an accurate next step.

Constraint

The same experiment wave covered different limits, products, surfaces and account states. The pattern had to stay reusable without turning every block into the same generic Pro pitch.

03 - The language turn

Replace a generic upgrade pitch with a task-specific blocker

BEFORE	AFTER
Upgrade to Pro	Reason for the block · relevant paid value · specific product · accurate next step

04 - The judgment

The decisions doing the work

01

State the reason for the block

Usage, file and feature limits are explained before the upgrade request, so the product answers why it interrupted the user.

02

Match benefits to the task

Translator prompts lead with continued translation; Write prompts lead with writing quality, style and product-specific access.

03

Account for existing subscriptions

A free user and an existing Translator Pro customer do not receive the same Write message, because the product and entitlement being added are different.

04

Make the available routes explicit

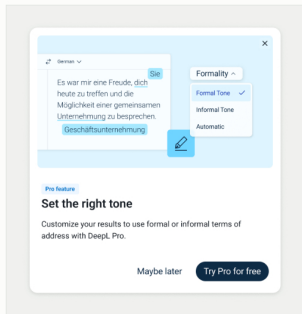
Where waiting or reducing the task remains possible, the content says so. Where upgrading is the only route forward, the blocker does not imply otherwise.

The trade-off: A single reusable modal would be easier to maintain. A shared structure with product- and limit-specific content takes more work, but keeps the upgrade request accurate and relevant.

05 - The interface

How the language changes the experience

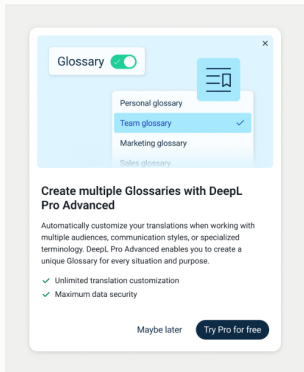
Formality



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The formality blocker connects the paid offer to the tone control the user was trying to access.

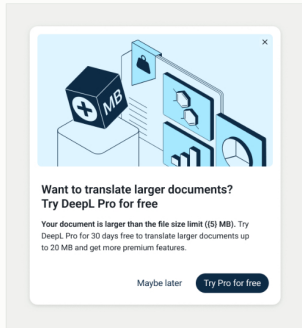
More glossaries



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The glossary blocker explains the product limit and keeps its benefits specific to terminology work.

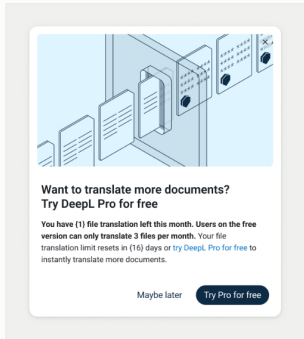
Larger documents



View larger

The document blocker ties the upgrade route directly to translating a file that exceeds the current limit.

Document allowance



View larger

This variant distinguishes the number of document translations remaining from a file-size limit and explains when the allowance resets.

Network usage



Write - Free account





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Maybe later

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Write surface

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The free-account Write surface carries the usage-limit reason into product-specific benefits, pricing and an upgrade action.